



Your Questions, Our Answers

All your computing niggles and nags are dealt with here!

High Definition Queries

What format should HD content should be in—AVI, DivX, MPEG4? Does Blu-ray use any other format? What does Java support in Blu-ray mean? Also, is there a way using which I can convert optical audio output to, say, 5.1 analog output?

naveen_reloaded on the Thinkdigit Forum

HD content can be stored in any of the formats—AVI, DivX or MP4. AVI and MP4 are both containers for the media. Any codec that supports HD resolutions can be used to encode. Blu-ray is encoded using MPEG2 or MPEG4-AVC—or what is more commonly known as H.264. Blu-ray Disc Java or BD-J is the Java used as the interface to interact with the content on a Blu-ray disc.

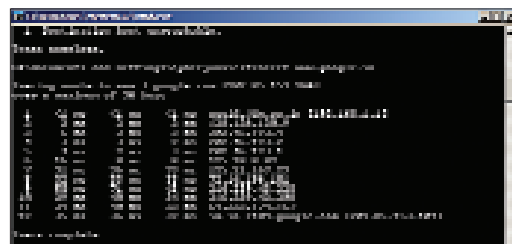
Optical to 3.5mm output convertors are pretty impossible to find. A DAC could be your best bet for digital (optical) to analog output but they are extremely expensive.

Poor Online Latency Issues

I was playing *Call of Duty 4* online via BSNL 2 Mbps (Home 1800 plan) connection and was very happy for a while. Now, suddenly the ping shoots up to 400 ms while it was only 120 ms before. Moreover, when I ping a server—even those in India, the ping fluctuates to over 100 ms. www.google.co.in gives me a ping of 400 ms. Is there anyway to rectify this problem?

Amitash on Thinkdigit Forum

If your pings spike up randomly from 120 ms to 400 ms, then it could be a problem on your ISP end due to load or bandwidth shortage. It could also be disturbance in the line between you and the ISP. If it's a stable 400ms ping, then it could be the change in routing by your ISP. That is—your ISP may be using a different path to send data across the Internet. Use the command—tracert <Game server IP> and see the path your ISP has taken. You could request your ISP to revert back



to the original routing and also ask them to check line disturbance.

Playback Statistics In Winamp

I use Winamp 5.33 and I want to see the most played songs and how many times they were played. How do I go about doing that?

ax3 on Thinkdigit Forum

The Winamp Library is the best way to find all the statistics for the songs you've been listening to. Winamp can also tell you which songs from the playlist you haven't heard at all. Press [Alt] + [L] with Winamp in focus to open the Winamp Library.

IP Hijacking?

I use the Internet through a cable connection which has a static IP address. Whenever I try to download from Rapidshare, I get time limitation warnings such as "Download limit exceeded. Wait for 80 minutes" or "You are already downloading a file. Please wait till it is over". For the last couple of months I have not downloaded a single file from Rapidshare. What is the matter? Has somebody hijacked my IP address? Can I get it back?

abhijitroy on Thinkdigit Forum

The issue could be with your ISP. It could be someone logging into your account and thus gaining access to your assigned IP. Change your password from time to time if you have to. If you connect to the Internet through a proxy server run on your ISP end, then you are very likely to keep getting that message. Also, try clearing your browsers cache and cookies.

PPPoE On Windows 98

How to connect to my broadband Internet connection through Windows 98? I have already connected to the same broadband using Windows XP from the same computer. I use the Ethernet port to connect the modem with my PC. Kindly guide me.

Aanand on Thinkdigit Forum

RASPPPoE is a PPPoE implementation made for Windows 95 / 98 / ME. Download it and unzip the files into a temporary folder. Uninstall any previous PPPoE software that you may have installed or got with your installation. Right-click on the Network Neighbourhood icon and right click on Properties. Click Add > Protocol > Add. Click Have Disk and point to the folder with the unzipped files. Select the INF file. Select PPP over Ethernet Controller. Go to Start > Run. Enter RASPPPoE and the application should run. Now create a dialup connection using the selected network adaptor.

Get Help Now!

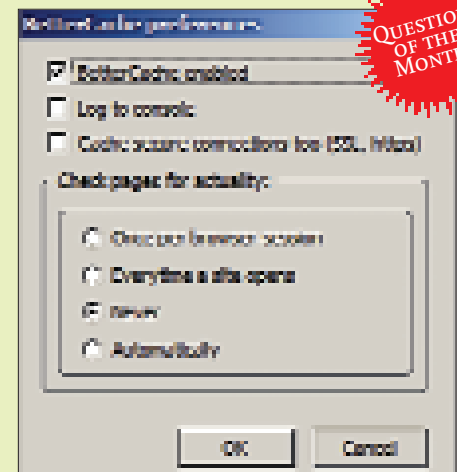
E-mail us your computing problems along with your contact details and complete system configuration to sos@thinkdigit.com, and we might answer them here! Since we get many more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!

Optimizing Firefox's Bandwidth Consumption

I use Firefox and it uses way more bandwidth than IE7 and Opera. I have set the cache size to 500 MB. It seems to take bandwidth to load recently visited pages despite the cache size. When I open Firefox it restores previous session but it uses bandwidth to load all the pages again. How do I force it to load from cache?

adithyagenius on Thinkdigit Forum

A lot of users use Internet schemes with data download limitations. Browsers like Firefox can really redownload many pages and images despite setting large cache. The problem is on the way pages are designed. A very good way to cut down on bandwidth is to install a Firefox plugin called BetterCache—<https://addons.mozilla.org/en-US/firefox/addon/6371>. Click on Install now to install the plugin. Restart Firefox then click on Tools > Add-ons. Click on Options for the BetterCache plugin. Check the radio button next to Never, under Check pages for actuality. This way Firefox will avoid looking for new versions of the pages or elements. The other solution you could try is to use a proxy server on your own system which caches pages better.



Stopping Public Access To Printer

I want to protect my office printer from unauthorised use. I have a single user account and all office colleagues use the same computer. Is there any way to lock the printer?

goldy_connect on Thinkdigit Forum

The easiest way to block access to printers is to first make sure the users using the same computer have separate accounts on Windows. Then, go to the Printer properties by clicking on Start > Control Panel > Printers and Faxes. Right-click on your printer and select Properties. Click on the Security tab and here you can set which accounts you want to give access to the printer and which you don't.

System Instability

I have a desktop with a 19-inch Viewsonic LCD, 160 GB hard drive, Intel Pentium 4 3 GHz, i865g motherboard with 1 GB of RAM and Windows XP SP2. Everything has been running fine, but recently I have some problems. *GTA III* works fine but *NFS: Most Wanted* and *Carbon* crash! So will a graphics card solve my problem? I have an AGP slot so what is the best and cheap solution for it? Should I change the motherboard and I don't want to change my processor! Please suggest a solution for under Rs 10,000.

bhadkow on Thinkdigit Forum

The problem with crashing could be to do with overheating components. Check for CPU temperatures just after running some heavy games. If your processor crosses 70-75C then that could be your problem. Clean up your cabinet and fans. A complete system upgrade would be recommended if you are one who plays lots of games. If you want something temporarily, you could find an AGP ATI Radeon x1800 or x1900 line of cards for around or under Rs 5,000 if you are lucky but that won't fix your crashing problems. The Radeons will run the *NFS* series perfectly fine.

Kaput BIOS

My BIOS has gotten corrupted. When my system boots up, it shows a message saying "BIOS ROM checksum error" and "Please insert

system disk" ("Award BIOS Bootblocker 1.0" is on the top of the page). So to correct this I downloaded the latest BIOS updates from the MSI site. I am going to get a startup floppy from one of my friends and flash the bios. Will a startup floppy created on my friends comp work on mine and will this solve the problem of the corrupt BIOS? Please help!

zodiac_511 on Thinkdigit Forum

The BIOS ROM checksum error does indicate the corrupted BIOS. The latest BIOS update is just a file that needs to be inserted into the floppy drive. The floppy with the BIOS firmware on it will work perfectly fine on the motherboard and should fix the corrupt BIOS.

False Alarm?

When I run Spybot Search and Destroy, it reports DSO Exploits. It appears to fix them, but when I run the scan again, it again reports the same DSO Exploits. Please help me, as I think that my system is at risk. I am running Windows XP SP2.

Yogesh Bendre

If you have SP2 installed, then you need not worry about these DSO Exploits warnings issued by Spybot because they are false alarms. Spybot removes the vulnerability by changing a registry value, but unfortunately, even the changed value continues to trigger this alarm, even though the Exploit has been disarmed already. To get rid of this annoyance, you need to do some registry editing. Navigate to HKEY_USERS\.\DEFAULT\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Internet Settings\Zones\0. Look for a value called 1004 in the right-hand pane. The type of this value should be REG_DWORD and its value should be 0x00000003. If this value does not exist, or if it exists but is the wrong type or has the wrong value, delete it and recreate it with the correct type and value. Repeat this step for the other entries listed by Spybot: HKEY_USERS\S-1-5-18\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Internet Settings\Zones\0 HKEY_USERS\S-1-5-19\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Inter